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1. Getting good at AI takes time and practice
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/getting-good-at-ai-takes-time-and-practice/
Many people think 1 that getting ?good at AI? is trivial. Sure, with some early models there were tricks you had to learn, 2 but current models don?t need them. Even if there are different tricks 3 that work on current models, the next generation will render them obsolete, so why bother? Just tell the model what you want it to do. This take is particularly popular with the anti-AI crowd, who scoff 4 at the idea that AI-reluctant people are being left behind, or that it might be irresponsible to advise other engineers to avoid AI use entirely. According to them, if AI does ever become capable enough to be worth using, they?ll be able to start using it with no learning curve. Is that right? No. Like most things, getting good at using AI isn?t just about clever tricks. It requires developing long-term skills 5 , which takes time and practice. Supplying the right context One failure mode I?ve seen with people who are new to AI is expecting it to read their mind: for instance, asking it to ?solve my issue? without ever saying what the issue is, or asking it about some Slack-related problem without actually connecting your agent to Slack. Agents are flexible and will try their absolute...

2. Quoting Ted Sanders
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-28T23:23:21+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/28/ted-sanders/
In general, LLM performance is incredibly multidimensional. There’s no guarantee of a fixed ordering where the model that is best at math is also the model that’s best at jokes. Despite that complexity, much of the variation in performance is explained by just a single variable: model size. In general, models that are bigger will (a) be more performant / reliable, (b) cost more per token, and (c) have better recall of esoteric facts. As you note, our models are ordered: Luna [...] These days, version number signifies a few things at once: the order of release, the relationship to other releases, and the magnitude of improvement. So something like 6.1 would indicate it was launched after 5.6, may share some similarities to other 6.1 models in terms of training data / personality (which is why it’s not 5.7), and isn’t a giant enough leap to merit the headlines and expectations that would come with a 7. ? Ted Sanders , explaining OpenAI’s model naming conventions Tags: generative-ai , gpt , openai , ai , llms , ted-sanders

3. GitHub Octoverse 2026
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-28T16:45:23+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/28/github-octoverse-2026/
GitHub Octoverse 2026 I’m at GitHub Universe today (GitHub gave me a free ticket through their "GitHub Stars" program). EVP Jay Parikh just announced this year’s Octoverse report, and highlighted these numbers in particular: This is a pretty stark representation of the impact of agentic engineering on GitHub. In 2026, merged pull requests tripled in less than a year to 220 million per month. Commits more than tripled to 7.38 billion per month, with most of that increase in the second half of this year. New repository rate doubled this year, to 30.3 million per month. The report includes new numbers by industry, and breaks out numbers for repositories that involve "interoperability or reverse engineering". The methodology section includes notes about how they did this: Top countries by pushes to public repositories, adjusted by profile location . Pushes from each country were summed across the Octoverse year. To adjust for biases caused by VPN usage, LLM classification was used to extract the ISO 3166-1 alpha-2 code from the profiles of GitHub users who contributed pushes during this period [...] Industry . Public repositories created 2022 to 2026 were sorted into NAICS sectors by...

4. The October inflection point for vibe game development
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-28T13:55:15+00:00

Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/28/vibe-game-development/
I've written before about how November 2025 was an inflection point for coding agents - the point where Opus 4.5 and GPT-5.1 crossed a tipping point that meant their respective coding agents became reliable daily drivers for software engineers. I think we've reached a new inflection point in October 2026, and this time it's for vibe coding computer games . Tree Appreciator Emberwick Battle Drones Pumpkin Farmer, aka Quarter Sun Cove Four times as insulting What happens if someone actually puts the work in? You should build a game! Claude Opus 5.5 in particular exhibits meaningful improvements in several areas needed to build a compelling game: 3D modeling Music generation (see Scrimshaw Jukebox) Game design (!) That last one is particularly important. Models have been able to create something that looks like a game for quite a while now, as seen in my previous experiments . The challenge has been getting to a game that's actually fun to play . Game design is a deep subject area. I won't pretend to be well versed in it - I know enough to have respect for it as a craft. Creating a novel, compelling gameplay loop which challenges players at the right level and provides a satisfying...

5. C++/WinRT overcorrection: Using make_self and immediately converting it to the projected interface
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261028-00/?p=112803/
You are taking the scenic route. The post C++/WinRT overcorrection: Using make_self and immediately converting it to the projected interface appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. Steven Levy on the New MacBook Pro, With, Yes, a Touchscreen
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-29T04:06:15Z
Link: https://www.wired.com/story/the-inside-story-of-why-apple-finally-brought-a-touch-display-to-the-mac/
Steven Levy, writing at Wired with the scoop on the new MacBook Pros (News+ link): This turnaround is a big deal to Apple fans. Ternus shrugs off the drama. ?The Mac is first and foremost an indirect input device, built around the trackpad and keyboard. But I think there?s times when it?s comfortable and handy to have touch.? Ternus and Apple want to make sure that the Mac faithful don?t panic that the 42-year-old franchise is losing its identity to Apple?s gangbusters mobile products. ?We needed to get to a point where adding touch didn?t make the product lesser in any way. It didn?t make it heavier. It didn?t make it thicker. That came together with the OLED screen, the best display we?ve ever put into a Mac,? Ternus told me. ?All of these things, and, oh yeah, it has touch as well.? After a long fun day of hands-on exploration, briefings, and a slew of demos, not just most, but all of my concerns about touchscreen support adversely affecting the Mac UI have been allayed. I love it. These seem like exquisite machines even if you never want to touch the screen. I think what Ternus told Levy captures the truth of touch?s role: ?All of these things, and, oh yeah, it has touch as...

7. Guessing the Name: MacBook Studio?
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-28T14:58:45Z
Link: https://www.macrumors.com/2026/10/28/macbook-studio/
Joe Rossignol, MacRumors: A teaser video shared by Apple CEO John Ternus today hints at a potential name for the rumored MacBook models with touch-enabled OLED displays: MacBook Studio. [...] Apple is expected to show off the new MacBooks to selected tech reporters and content creators at an experience in Los Angeles at 10 a.m. Pacific Time today, and that is the home of Hollywood movie studios after all. I went to bed last night thinking ?MacBook Studio? was the best guess. I woke up this morning feeling like it was a name worth betting on. It just fits. There?s a Mac Studio desktop, Studio Display monitor, and Apple?s suite of pro software tools is named Creator Studio ? and they just announced big updates to that yesterday. As I suggested yesterday , these should be a new MacBook line, not the new MacBook Pros. If this is the name, Rossignol gets the Being Right Point for calling it. (A bunch of readers chimed in to suggest ?MacBook Touch?. That wouldn?t work for the same reasons that Apple didn?t even consider

calling the Duo the ?iPhone Fold?. Yes, they used ?Touch? for the iPod Touch of yore, but (a) that was a different era, and (b) that was such a mediocre product name tha...

8. What?s Left for ?Pro and Tell? Week: Touch-Enabled OLED MacBooks
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-27T17:59:47Z
Link: https://www.macrumors.com/2026/10/27/macbook-pro-with-touchscreen-tomorrow/
Joe Rossignol, MacRumors: Apple on Wednesday will announce 14-inch and 16-inch MacBook Pro models featuring touch-enabled OLED displays with thinner bezels, a Dynamic Island instead of a notch, M5 Pro and M5 Max chips, and a lighter and slightly thinner design, Bloomberg?s Mark Gurman reports . Apple is hosting a private ?Pro and tell? experience in Los Angeles starting at 10 a.m. Pacific Time tomorrow. I?m here in LA for the press shindig tomorrow. One thing I?ve been thinking about regarding these reported touch-enabled OLED MacBooks is that Gurman has reported for months that these new MacBooks will sport M5 Pro and M5 Max chips. Here?s Gurman back on June 26 : The MacBook models, positioned at the top of Apple?s lineup, will arrive between late this year and early next year, according to people with knowledge of the matter. They?re planned to be powered by the existing M5 Pro and M5 Max chips, said the people, who asked not to be identified because the plans are private. [...] The first touch-screen 14-inch and 16-inch models, code-named K114 and K116, will represent the biggest overhaul of Apple?s high-end laptops since the company began moving away from Intel Corp. chips in...

9. Psychometrics, vaccines, meat, Kowloon, luggage destruction
Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-10-28T00:00:00+00:00
Link: https://dynomight.net/shorts-8/
This is a real paper that actually exists Assessing the Psychometric Properties of the Dynomight? MBTI: A Comparative Analysis with the Original Myers-Briggs Type Indicator. Journal of Psychology and Behavior Studies , 4 (1), 27-37. Zrari, A., & Sakale, S. (2024). A cohort of n=77 participants consented to engage in the study, meeting the inclusion criteria of being currently enrolled at the Tulua institution and expressing willingness to participate in both the initial assessment and the follow-up session. To assess the longitudinal consistency of the Dynomight? MBTI, a second administration of the test was scheduled six weeks after the initial session. [?] Empirical findings, as delineated in Table 1, manifested significant positive correlations across all dichotomies, indicative of a substantial concordance between the two assessments. The correlation coefficient for the Introversion-Extroversion axis was notably high (r = .938, p ?Dynomight?? is repeated in text 77 times. Yeast vaccines More is Different has a post on yeast-based vaccines, describing both why yeast-based vaccines are cool (if not self-evident) and how IRB rules can violate free speech and bodily autonomy make...

10. Pluralistic: Agents vs ecommerce (28 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 10:54:05 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/28/principle-agent-problem/
Today’s links Agents vs ecommerce: Opacity is a feature, not a bug. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Aibo hacking; Calculator watches; What hath Occupy wrought; Dr Seuss v Trek parody; "Blacks for Trump" x murder-cults; "9 Times My Work Has Been Ripped Off." Upcoming appearances: Vienna, Kilkenny, Courtenay, Vancouver, Folkestone, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. Agents vs ecommerce (permalink) The first widely read piece of tech criticism I ever wrote was "Metacrap: Putting the torch to the seven strawmen of the meta-utopia," a response to the underlying philosophy of the "Semantic Web" that I published in 2001: https://people.well.com/user/doctorow/metacrap.htm The piece holds up surprisingly well today (if I do say so myself), and not just for its criticism of the ontological incoherence of "web semantics." The most relevant concept I develop in that piece is a criticism of any plan that starts with "first, everyone else in the world just needs to set aside their needs a...

11. The Unbalanced Group Theorem
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 11:51:51 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/28/the-unbalanced-group-theorem/
The classification of finite simple groups (CFSG) has been called the biggest theorem in mathematics. It is big, not necessarily in terms of its importance, but in the sense that its proof developed over the course of decades and thousands of pages of journal articles. Two days ago Axiom announced it had formalized the proof [?] The post The Unbalanced Group Theorem first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Gadget Review: SoundPEATS CC3 Pro Bluetooth Headphones ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 12:34:54 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/gadget-review-soundpeats-cc3-pro-bluetooth-headphones/
These are easily the most comfortable headphones I've worn. I've literally had them clipped around my ears all day without noticing them. The good folks at SoundPEATS have sent me their latest cans to wrap around my lugs. I'm a big fan of these new-style "clip on" headphones. Rather than encasing your ears, or sticking way down into the wax-mines, these clip over your ear. It isn't a tight?

13. This Week in Source Control: 28 October 2026
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-28T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/28/this-week-in-source-control.html
Alongside package management, I follow new features and security fixes in source control clients and in the forges that host repositories, since a lot of what I build, like git-pkgs , reads git repositories and calls forge APIs. This Week in Package Management has been published every Saturday since May, and I kept putting git releases and forge news in its Elsewhere section. Starting this week, I?m publishing that material as a separate roundup on Wednesdays. It covers clients like git, jj, gitoxide, Sapling, Mercurial and Git LFS, and forges like GitHub, GitLab, Forgejo, Gitea, Codeberg, sourcehut, Radicle and Tangled. Package managers resolving git dependencies and CI systems like GitHub Actions are covered in the Saturday post. This first issue covers the fortnight since 11 October, with links from release feeds for those tools and forges, the Lobsters vcs tag , Hacker News and my boosts on Mastodon . In that fortnight Anthropic, GitHub, Entire and Enroute each published a post about rebuilding source control or git hosting for the volume of pushes and checkouts from coding agents. Scaling Redesigning source control at Anthropic (Anthropic Engineering) describes Scion, an in-h...

14. Exit Liquidity
Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 17:51:00 GMT
Link: https://www.wheresyoured.at/exit-liquidity/
I?m taking a week off of premium as I?ve had a family situation that has absorbed a lot of my time this week, but I?ll be back with a barnburner next Friday (11/6). In the interim, I?m running a week-

15. Fake it ?til you make it (and then keep faking it)
Source: Experimental History | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 15:36:04 GMT
Link: https://www.experimental-history.com/p/fake-it-til-you-make-it-and-then
links ?n? updates